

Science · GROW · Autumn 1 · Week 08 · SCI-GROW-A1-W08-P1 · Date _____

The Moon's Journey

Today I can... ☐ State that the Moon orbits Earth in roughly a month ☐ Explain that moonlight is reflected sunlight ☐ Explain phases using our changing view of the lit half

Feedback: ☐ VF ☐ WS ☐ I ☐ NS ☐ E ☐ R _____

**The Moon's Journey**

Reference only · record your answers in your book.

Learning goal: I can explain why the Moon appears to change shape as it orbits Earth.

Word	Meaning
satellite	an object that orbits a planet
phase	the shape of the lit part of the Moon visible from Earth
orbit	a curved path around another body
reflected	light that changes direction from a surface

Key ideas

- Torch is the Sun, ball is the Moon, observer is Earth. Keep the sunlight direction fixed.
- Half the Moon is illuminated by the Sun. As it orbits, our view of the illuminated half changes.
- When the visible lit half faces us, we see full Moon. When it faces away, we see new Moon.
- Trace the light path: Sun → Moon → observer on Earth. Name the Sun as light source and the Moon as reflecting object.

Keep the claim fair

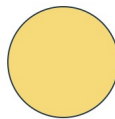
The model does not show realistic sizes, distances or the tilt of the Moon's orbit.



new Moon



half Moon



full Moon

Views from Earth; not to scale. The ball stays round at every position.

New, half and full are views from Earth. The Moon stays round; its visible lit part changes.